The instrument specification: every check as a hypothesis

Generated by `scripts/instrument.py` from `assessment/instrument/RULE-*.yaml` under DN-015 (`docs/design/2026-10-15_DN-015_instrument_specification.md`). Each row answers the operator's four questions: is it a valid question; what behavior a published source expects; what test the harness runs and whether it is the recognized one; and what a result does and does not claim. A check is `specified` only when every branch of its rule rests on a published behavior; page two of the summary shows only `specified` checks that are not declarations.

Terms used throughout: **SI client (SI system)**: a system that finds, reads and uses data on its own, such as an answer engine, an agent or a retrieval pipeline; the project's term for what is elsewhere called an AI system; **data page**: an agency's own web page for one data product, the page the harness measures (also 'product page' in rule code); **harness**: this project's scanner: an identified, robots-compliant HTTP client that fetches the pages and records what it met; **cycle of record**: the scan whose results the published grid is built from (here scan_2026-10-07_composite_d); **recorded location**: an address for an agency's API, terms, changelog or inventory that the harness was given, read from the agency's own pages or seeded from a named source; **error / not measured**: the harness could not observe: an access denial, its own robots compliance, an absence it could not confirm, or a server or network error; never a fail; **leg**: one check as the harness runs it, named by its indicator code (A1, D4); each leg has one rule, and the codes in a test field name other legs whose fetches this one reuses; **rule / branch**: the versioned code that turns observations into a verdict; a branch is one way the rule can reach a verdict, with its own reason text; **Observation**: one recorded fetch (request, response, parsed content) that a rule judges; **surface**: the page a verdict is about: a data page, or for site-level checks the agency's home host; **body**: the agency, as the harness's records name it; **complete search**: an absence is reported as a fail only when every candidate location was observed and every named source searched; otherwise the verdict is error (DN-012); **seed source**: a named place a recorded location came from: the agency's own developer page, catalog.data.gov, api.data.gov, this repository's citations, or a model's knowledge, each recorded per location; **params.***: a named parameter in the harness's configuration file (assessment/harness/scan/params.yaml); its value is stated where it matters.

#	Check	Question	Expected behavior (source)	Test, and whether it is the recognized one	A pass claims	A fail claims	Neither claims	State
1	**A13** `RULE-A13-v1`: Page reaches the agency's API, terms, changelog, inventory	Can a machine client that starts at a data page, and knows nothing else, reach the four objects an agency publishes for machines (its API, the API's terms, its changelog, its data inventory)? An SI client usually arrives at a data page from a search result; if the objects behind it cannot be reached from there, the client cannot use them, however well they are built.	Two published discovery conventions exist for two of the four objects. For the API: a publisher supporting RFC 9727 resolves a GET to /.well-known/api-catalog with an API catalog document (§2), and may also include the api-catalog link relation in the HTTP header or content of its pages (§3, quoted). For the inventory: each agency must post its inventory to www.[agency].gov/data.json (M-25-05 §5(b)(ii)). No published source defines how a client starting at a data page should reach the API's terms or the changelog, and none names an ordinary hyperlink from a data page as the discovery mechanism for any of the four objects; those parts of this check are the project's own. Sources: `rfc-9727-api-catalog` §2 Using the api-catalog well-known URI; §3 The api-catalog link relation; `m-25-05-phase-2-implementation-of-the-`	RFC 9727 defines its own client behavior (GET /.well-known/api-catalog; read the Link header), and the harness's convention branches follow it. The /data.json branch follows M-25-05's address. There is no published method for "reachable from a data page by a link", and none for combining four objects into one verdict; both are this project's.	Every object the agency is shown to publish is either linked from this data page or sits at its published convention address.	At least one object the agency is shown to publish (named in the reason) is neither linked from this data page nor at a convention address the harness checked: /data.json at the root of the data page's own host (an inventory at www.[agency].gov while the data page is on a subdomain is not matched there) and /.well-known/api-catalog served as application/linkset+json. For the API's terms and the changelog no published convention exists, so a fail on either rests only on this project's link criterion and is not a breach of any published convention. It is not a claim that the object is missing, nor that a client told where to look cannot use it.	Nothing about whether the objects work, are documented, or are reachable from any other page on the site; nothing about pages the harness did not read.	**project_defined**. The v2 audit said no branch is invented; at the branch level three are. The two published branches are the convention addresses (RFC 9727 for the API, /data.json for the inventory). The link-reachability branch (an ordinary hyperlink from the data page) has no published definition for any object, and the terms and changelog objects have no published discovery convention at all, so their fail branches rest on the project's own notion of discoverability; the four-object composite is the project's too. The task's premise

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			`evidence-act-open-gove` §4(a)(iii); §5(b)(ii) (www.[agency].gov/data.json).					named two invented branches (terms and changelog reachability); this entry finds those two and the link branch beneath all four.
2	**A2** `RULE-A2-v6`: OpenAPI description served at the recorded API address	Does the agency publish a machine-readable description of its data API? An SI client that is to call an API rather than scrape pages needs to know the calls, their parameters and what they return; a description a program can read lets it build the call without a person reading documentation first.	A publisher that offers an API provides complete information about it on the Web (DWBP Best Practice 25), and DWBP's test for that practice is that every call is described, with its required and optional parameters and what it returns (quoted). DWBP adds that complete documentation also enables machines to access it (quoted). The OpenAPI Specification defines a description that lets humans and computers discover and understand a service's capabilities, and its required `openapi` field is defined as "the version number of the OpenAPI Specification that the OpenAPI document uses" (OAS 3.2.0 §1, §4.1.1, quoted). Where a publisher announces its APIs through an RFC 9727 API catalog, the catalog is RECOMMENDED to include links to the OpenAPI definitions, and metadata not in the catalog SHOULD be available at the API endpoint URIs it lists (RFC 9727 §4.1, quoted). No source requires a description to be OpenAPI rather than another format, or requires it at the API's base address when no API catalog is published; those requirements in this check's fail	DWBP's own tests for the expected behavior are: "Check if a test client can simulate calls and the API returns the expected responses" (BP 23) and "Check that every call enabled by your API is described in your documentation" (BP 25). The harness does neither: it makes no call to the API and reads no human documentation. It checks one thing OAS defines (is this document an OpenAPI description?) at one place no source requires (the recorded base). There is no published conformance test for "the agency publishes a machine-readable API description".	An OpenAPI or Swagger description document is served at the API address recorded for this agency (the address is named in the cell's reason).	No OpenAPI or Swagger document was found at the API addresses recorded for this agency; where no API address is recorded at all, the fail says only that none was found in the sources searched. A fail is not a claim that the agency has no API, that its API is undocumented, that it publishes no machine-readable description anywhere (a description at a developer portal, or in another format such as a catalog document at the API root, is not looked for), or that its API refuses scripts. Two of the cycle's fails say in their own reason that the API is present, and three more found a document at the API address that is not OpenAPI.	Nothing about whether the API works, whether its human documentation is complete, whether search engines or Dataset Search can find it, or whether a key is required.	**invalid**. Invalid by DN-015 §7: the reader answered no to question 1 in both rounds (its round-2 reason is recorded under reader_invalid). The defect it names is in this entry's quoting of its sources, not shown to be in the rule; before the reading, the writer's assessment was: state project_defined. The pass branch is published (an OpenAPI description is the OAS-defined machine description, and serving it where the API lives is what RFC 9727 §4.1 recommends). Both fail branches penalize a behavior no source requires: having no OpenAPI document at the recorded base, which an agency with a fully documented API in another form also does. Every v3 grid fail on this column rests on one

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			branches are the project's own. Sources: `w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 25 (statement, intended outcome, How to Test); `openapi-specification-core` §1 (What is the OpenAPI Specification); §4.1.1 Fixed Fields (`openapi` REQUIRED); `rfc-9727-api-catalog` §4.1 API Catalog Contents.					of them, so the column's fails do not carry a published claim.
3	**A1** `RULE-A1-v5`: Page links a structured data file	Is the data offered in a structured, machine-readable format? An SI client can read a CSV, JSON or spreadsheet file directly; a PDF table has to be extracted and re-parsed, which is where numbers are misread.	The publisher makes the data available in a machine-readable, standardized data format (DWBP Best Practice 12, quoted). For federal public data assets this is required: "Agencies must make each of their public data assets machine-readable" (M-25-05 §5(a)(i), quoted), and machine-readable means a format that can be easily processed by a computer without human intervention (M-25-05, quoted). USAFacts names the formats: JSON, CSV, machine-readable Excel, and not PDF (quoted). Sources: `w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 12: Use machine-readable standardized data formats; `m-25-05-phase-2-implementation-of-the-evidence-act-open-gove` Definitions (machine-readable); §5(a)(i) Machine-Readable; `usafacts-ai-ready-data-guide` §1 Accessible, How?.	DWBP's test for Best Practice 12 is "Check if the data format conforms to a known machine-readable data format specification". The harness reads the format the server declares (the registered media type) rather than validating the file, which is a weaker form of the same test; it is the method a client uses to decide how to parse a response.	A link on this data page, on the page's own host, returned a file that the server declared (by media type) or the address named (by extension) as a structured data format: CSV, JSON, XML, spreadsheet or Parquet.	Every on-host link in this data page's HTML, as served before any script runs, was checked (links built by scripts or reached by form posts are not seen), and none was declared, by its media type or its file extension, as a structured data format. It is not a claim that the page links no structured file (a real data file served with a generic media type and no extension is missed), nor that the agency publishes no machine-readable data: data offered on another host (a data portal, an API) or reached only through a query tool is outside this page's on-host links.	Nothing about whether the structured file is complete, current, documented, or the same data the page shows.	**specified**. Every branch rewards or penalizes a behavior DWBP BP 12, M-25-05 and USAFacts define (data in a structured format; not PDF only). The frame (this page's on-host links) and the media-type list are test properties stated above (DN-015 §4); the claims are bounded to them. On the cycle of record no grid page reached a fail on this check: every non-pass was not measured.
4	**A3** `RULE-A3-v8`: Page links an archive or large	Can the whole dataset be retrieved in one request? An SI client that must assemble a product	"Enable consumers to retrieve the full dataset with a single request" (DWBP Best Practice 17, quoted). M-23-22 §III.4 adds, for federal sites: if an agency detects significant public interest in	DWBP's test is "Check if the full dataset can be retrieved with a single request". The harness cannot know the full dataset's extent, so it	This data page links, on its own host, an archive file (by extension) or a file that is not an HTML page,	Every on-host link in this data page's HTML, as served before any script runs, was checked (a download offered through a script-driven button or a	Nothing about whether the file is complete or current, or	**specified**. Each branch rewards or penalizes the behavior DWBP BP 17 defines (the full dataset in one

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	unfiltered file	from many filtered queries makes many calls, can miss parts, and cannot tell when it has all of it; a bulk file answers that in one request.	scraping information from its web pages, it should strongly consider making that information available as machine-readable data that can be accessed in bulk (quoted). Sources: `w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 17: Provide bulk download; `omb-m-23-22-digital-first-public-experience` §III.4 Information and Services That Are Discoverable and Optimized for Search.	uses a proxy: an archive, or an unfiltered non-HTML file over a size floor. The proxy is this project's; no published method exists for deciding from outside that a file is the whole of a statistical product.	carries no query string in its address, and is at least 50 KiB. It is not verified to be the complete product.	form post is not seen), and none is an archive or a non-HTML file without a query string of at least 50 KiB. The two tests are proxies: a link with a query string may still deliver the whole product, and a complete product smaller than 50 KiB fails the size floor. It is not a claim that the agency's downloads are partial, nor that no bulk download exists elsewhere (a data portal, an FTP site, an API bulk endpoint).	whether bulk access exists off this page.	request). The size floor and the query-string rule are test parameters chosen by this project, stated with their error modes (DN-015 §4); the pass claim says the file is not verified to be the whole product. On the cycle of record no grid page reached a fail on this check.
5	**A4** `RULE-A4-v1`: robots.txt permits eight listed crawler tokens (a declaration)	Does the host's declared crawler policy let SI systems' crawlers fetch the data page? Answer engines that ground on the live web honor robots.txt; a page their crawler is told not to fetch is not read by that engine.	What robots.txt means is defined by RFC 9309: crawlers match the group for their product token case-insensitively and obey its rules (§2.2, quoted); a robots.txt that answers with a status in the 400-499 range is "unavailable", and then the crawler MAY access any resources on the server (§2.3.1.3, quoted); the rules are not a form of access authorization (§1, quoted). Which token governs which use is stated by each vendor: Google says robots.txt directives for Googlebot are the control for how a site is crawled for Search, into which its AI features are built, and that Google-Extended limits AI training and grounding in other systems (quoted); OpenAI says disallowing GPTBot means content should not be used in training, and recommends allowing OAI-SearchBot to appear in ChatGPT	Parsing robots.txt per RFC 9309 and evaluating the path per token is the protocol's own procedure and is correctly done. What it yields is the host's declared policy, not whether a crawler can reach the page (that is enforcement, observed by A12 and by the `refused` error class).	The host's robots.txt, as declared, permits each of eight listed crawler tokens to fetch the data page's path.	Either the host serves no robots.txt (which, under the robots.txt standard, permits every crawler), or its robots.txt tells at least one listed crawler not to fetch the path. Neither is a claim that crawlers cannot reach the data: robots.txt is a declaration, not a barrier, and disallowing a training crawler does not keep a page out of answer engines.	Nothing about whether a crawler is actually served or refused at the edge (A12), or about crawlers not on the list, including Googlebot and OAI-SearchBot.	**invalid**. Both fail branches enforce a behavior their own cited sources say is not the construct. A missing robots.txt permits every crawler (RFC 9309 §2.3.1.3), and five of the eight listed tokens are training controls whose vendors say disallowing them keeps content out of training, not out of answers; the two tokens their vendors name as the answer-engine controls are not listed. The check is also a declaration presented on the v3 grid as what a machine met. A new rule version would list the answer-

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			search results (quoted); Anthropic says restricting ClaudeBot signals exclusion from model training (quoted). CCBot has no source in the corpus. None of these sources states a readiness requirement to permit any token. This project's reading, marked as its own: a publisher that wants to be read by answer engines permits their search crawlers; whether it permits training crawlers is a separate choice that no cited source treats as a failure. Sources: `rfc-9309-robots-exclusion-protocol` §1; §2.2; §2.3.1.3 'Unavailable' Status; `google-ai-features-and-your-website` Controlling your content in AI features in Search; `openai-crawlers-bots` OAI-SearchBot; GPTBot; `anthropic-crawler-support-article` ClaudeBot.				engine tokens, read the training tokens separately as a declared preference, and treat an absent robots.txt as permission.
6	**A5** `RULE-A5-v2`: The site's sitemap lists the data page	Is the data page listed in the host's sitemap? Search engines and answer engines discover pages by following links and reading sitemaps; on a large site, a page a sitemap omits can go undiscovered, and an SI client cannot cite a page its retrieval layer never found.	Federal agencies should employ best practices to improve crawling or indexing, including sitemaps (M-23-22 §III.4, quoted). The sitemaps protocol defines the file: its location bounds the URLs it may list, it may be declared in robots.txt, and it is expected to list URLs from a single host only (quoted). Google defines what a sitemap is for: it "tells search engines which pages and files you think are important in your site" (quoted); a site of about 500 pages or fewer that is comprehensively linked might not need one, and on large sites it is harder to make sure every page is linked (quoted). The check	Reading the sitemap and looking for the URL is what a crawler does with it (sitemaps protocol). No published method defines a pass/fail for "the page is listed"; the harness's rule (listed or not) is the direct reading.	A sitemap served on the agency's host lists this data page's address, exactly as the harness records it.	The host's sitemaps were read and none lists this data page's address in exactly the form the harness records (a trailing slash, redirect target or query-string variant does not match), or the only discovery file served is an llms.txt (which by its proposal summarises a site rather than listing every page), or no sitemap is served at the standard locations. The reason names which. It is not a claim that the page is absent from the sitemap in every form, nor that search	Nothing about whether the page is indexed by any engine, or about sitemaps on other hosts.	**specified**. Each branch rewards or penalizes the behavior M-23-22 §III.4 asks of federal sites (use sitemaps), read by the sitemaps protocol's own semantics. The URL-form and llms.txt confounds are stated; the fail claim says discovery does not depend on a sitemap alone.

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			takes an agency's data page to be among the pages its owner thinks important; that premise is the framework's, not a source's. Sources: `omb-m-23-22-digital-first-public-experience` §III.4; `sitemaps-protocol` Sitemap file location; Specifying the Sitemap location in your robots.txt file; https://developers.google.com/search/docs/crawling-indexing/sitemaps/overview Do I need a sitemap?.			engines cannot find the page: well-linked pages are found without a sitemap.		
7	**A6** `RULE-A6-v2`: Page markup declares a named, described dataset	Does the data page carry structured markup that tells a machine it describes a dataset? Search engines' dataset indexes, and answer engines that draw on them, recognise a dataset page by its schema.org Dataset or DCAT markup; without it the page is read as an ordinary web page.	Google recommends adding structured data about a dataset to its canonical page, and reads it as schema.org Dataset markup or equivalent W3C DCAT structures (quoted), in JSON-LD (preferred), RDFa or Microdata (quoted). Google's required properties for a Dataset include description ("A short summary describing a dataset") and name ("A descriptive name of a dataset"), and it must include the required properties to be eligible for display (quoted). Schema.org defines Dataset as "A body of structured information describing some topic(s) of interest" (quoted). Sources: `google-dataset-structured-data` Our approach to dataset discovery; Structured data type definitions, Dataset, Required properties; `schema-org-dataset` Dataset.	Google's documented test is its Rich Results Test, which checks the same required properties; SHACL is the W3C language for validating an RDF graph against shapes. The harness applies the required properties through SHACL. It does not render JavaScript, while Google's crawler does, so markup injected by script is not seen.	The data page's own markup, as served before any script runs, declares a dataset with a name and a description (and any distribution it declares carries an access address).	The data page's markup, as served before any script runs, does not declare a dataset, or declares one that fails the minimal shapes: a name or description missing, or a declared distribution without an access address (the reason names the violation). It is not a claim that a dataset declared with a name and description is missing when the failing shape is the distribution's, nor that the agency's datasets are absent from Dataset Search: catalog pages, data.gov records and other pages may carry the markup.	Nothing about the quality or completeness of the description beyond the required properties, or about markup on other pages.	**invalid**. Invalid by DN-015 §7: the reader answered no to question 1 in both rounds (its round-2 reason is recorded under reader_invalid). The defect it names is in this entry's quoting of its sources, not shown to be in the rule; before the reading, the writer's assessment was: state specified. Each branch rewards or penalizes the behavior Google's dataset documentation defines (schema.org Dataset or DCAT markup with name and description on the page that describes the dataset). The no-render limit and the DataCatalog

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								gap are stated confounds.
8	**A8** `RULE-A8-v4`: Markup dates the data; a latest-version link resolves	Can a machine tell which release of the data it is reading, and find the latest one? An SI client that cannot read a release date may quote a superseded figure as current; one that cannot find the latest release cannot correct itself.	Each dataset carries a version number or date that a computer application can detect (DWBP Best Practice 7 and its test, quoted). URIs are assigned to individual versions and to the overall series, so agents can refer to "the latest version" (Best Practice 11, quoted). DCAT-US names the date as Last Update: "Most recent date on which the dataset was changed, updated or modified" (quoted). An HTTP Last-Modified header is a different fact: the time the origin server believes the selected representation was last modified (RFC 9110 §8.8.2, quoted), not the release the data belongs to. Sources: `w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 7: Provide a version indicator; Best Practice 11: Assign URIs to dataset versions and series; `dcat-us-1-1-schema` modified (Last Update); https://www.rfc-editor.org/rfc/rfc9110.txt §8.8.2 Last-Modified.	DWBP's test is "Check if a computer application can automatically detect/discover and process the unique version number or date of a dataset or distribution", which reading markup fields implements. No published test exists for the latest-version pointer; following the page's own latest links and requiring a 2xx is this project's.	The data page's markup carries a release or modification date (in dateModified or datePublished; or temporalCoverage, a branch this entry marks project-defined), and a latest-version link on the same host, recognised by its link relation, address or anchor text, resolves.	The data page's markup does not carry a date in the three fields read (dateModified, datePublished, temporalCoverage), or carries one but none of up to three recognised latest-version links on its own host resolves. It is not a claim that the agency does not date or version its releases: a version number, a date in another markup field, in visible text, a PDF or a catalog record, and a latest link worded otherwise, beyond the third, or on another host are not read.	Nothing about whether the date is correct or the data current.	**project_defined**. Four branches are published (DWBP BP 7 and BP 11; RFC 9110 for the Last-Modified distinction). One pass branch credits schema.org temporalCoverage, the period the data covers, as a release date, which no source supports. On the cycle of record the one grid pass names dateModified, so no grid cell rests on that branch, but the check as specified can produce one; a rule version that drops temporalCoverage from the date fields would make the check specified.
9	**A9** `RULE-A9-v2`: A probed machine address returns non-HTML content	Does the agency serve an entry point built for machine clients (an API description, an agent-protocol endpoint, an llms.txt) where such clients look first? Agents increasingly look	No published standard defines a "machine-first entry point" or names the set of addresses a ready publisher serves one at. Its parts have separate sources of unequal standing: an OpenAPI description (OAS, a specification), /llms.txt (a proposal, llmstxt.org), and /.well-known/mcp, which is not a registered well-known URI and	None published; the probe set and the any-non-HTML-2xx rule are this project's.	At least one of the addresses this project probes (the recorded API base and its description, /.well-known/mcp, /llms.txt) returned content that is not an HTML page.	None of the handful of addresses this project probes, by plain GET with no key and no Accept header, returned non-HTML content. The recorded API address may be stale or wrong, and an API that answers a bare request with an HTML page or an error page fails the same way. It is not a	Nothing about whether the content found is useful, documented or an entry point in any published sense.	**project_defined**. The construct has no published definition, and the decision rule (any non-HTML 2xx at a project-chosen probe set) is the project's. It is a frontier leg by its own record; it stays in the detailed report

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		for these before reading pages.	has no source in the corpus. Sources: none.			claim that the agency has no API, that its API is down, or that it lacks machine access.		as such and comes off page two.
10	**A10** `RULE-A10-v3`: Data tool answers with real status and content	Does the agency's interactive data tool answer a machine client honestly: real content at a deep link, and a real error for a route that does not exist? An SI client that receives HTTP 200 with an error page, or an empty shell that needs a browser to fill, records a page that is not there or reads nothing.	A route that does not exist answers 404 (or 410): "the origin server did not find a current representation for the target resource" (RFC 9110 §15.5.5). A 200 whose content says the page is an error is a soft 404, which Google treats as an error, not a page. A deep link to the product is served (not 4xx/5xx). No cited source requires a data tool's content to be present before JavaScript runs: Google's own crawler renders JavaScript ("Googlebot queues all pages with a 200 HTTP status code for rendering"), and the app-shell model it describes is supported. Sources: https://www.rfc-editor.org/rfc/rfc9110.txt §15.5.5 404 Not Found; https://developers.google.com/crawling/docs/troubleshooting/http-status-codes 200 (success): soft 404 error; https://developers.google.com/search/docs/crawling-indexing/javascript/javascript-seo-basics How Google processes JavaScript; app shell model.	Requesting a route known not to exist and reading the status is the standard soft-404 probe (it is what Search Console reports). Counting visible characters before JavaScript has no published method or threshold.	The tool's deep link was served with at least 2000 characters of text before any script ran, and a made-up route under the tool returned a non-200 status.	One of three things, named in the reason: a made-up route under the tool returned HTTP 200 (a soft 404, which may be a platform or CDN default rather than the agency's choice); the deep link itself returned an error status; or fewer than 2000 visible characters were present before scripts ran (a short page with a script-built table fails the same way as an empty shell). It is not a claim that the tool is unusable by a browser or by a crawler that renders JavaScript, nor a finding about the agency's intent.	Nothing about the tool's API, its data, or what a rendering client sees.	**project_defined**. The soft-404 and deep-link branches are published (RFC 9110; Google's soft-404 definition). The pass requires, and one fail branch penalizes, content before JavaScript, which no cited source asks of a data tool and Google's own documentation says it renders. On the cycle of record the one grid fail is a soft 404 (specified), but every grid pass rests on the project-defined floor.
11	**B3** `RULE-B3-v4`: Page links a methodology readable as text	Can a machine reach the methodology behind the data and read it? An SI client explaining a figure needs how it was collected and	USAFacts' criterion 2 is that data be "Machine Understandable with Easily Retrievable" documentation (quoted heading); AI models need context such as collection methodology (quoted), agencies should disclose methodologies for derived or	None published. Following the page's methodology links and reading the document as a non-rendering crawler would is the direct reading of USAFacts §4; the token and the two	A link on this data page whose address or text contains 'methodolog' leads to an HTML or text document with at least 2000	No link on this data page whose address or text contains 'methodolog' (up to 25 such links followed) leads to a document meeting the project's text thresholds: at least 2000 visible characters before	Nothing about the methodology's quality or completeness.	**project_defined**. Three branches follow published behaviors: a methodology linked from the data page (USAFacts §2), not PDF only (M-23-22

#	Check	Question	Expected behavior (source)	Test, and whether it is the recognized one	A pass claims	A fail claims	Neither claims	State
		estimated; a methodology it cannot reach, or can reach only as a PDF or behind a script, is context it will not use.	transformed datasets (quoted), and text documentation, methodology included, should be accessible to both humans and AI/web crawlers (§4, quoted). M-23-22 §III.9.b: an agency should develop online content in a non-HTML format only if a specific user need requires it (quoted). That the methodology should be readable without running scripts is this project's reading of "accessible to web crawlers", many of which do not run scripts; no source states it. Sources: `usafacts-ai-ready-data-guide` §2 Understandable; §4 Open; `omb-m-23-22-digital-first-public-experience` §III.9.b Software Development Principles: Default to HTML.	thresholds are this project's.	visible characters before any script runs and no more than a quarter of its text in links.	scripts run and link density at most 0.25. A readable short page or a chapter hub can fail those thresholds. It is not a claim that the methodology needs scripts or is unreadable, nor that the agency publishes no methodology: one linked as 'technical documentation', 'about the data' or from another page is not found.		§III.9.b), readable as text (USAFacts §4). The pass branch and the thin-or-navigation fail require the methodology to be readable before any script runs, which is this project's reading of "accessible to web crawlers" and which no cited source states (the same pattern that makes A10's shell branch project-defined). A rule version that judged the text after rendering, or dropped the pre-script condition, would make the check specified.
12	**D1** `RULE-D1-v6`: Page or API terms name a recognised licence	Can a machine tell on what terms it may use the data? An SI client, or the developer behind it, needs to know the data may be reused; for federal data that is usually public domain, but a client cannot assume what is not stated.	"Provide a link to or copy of the license agreement that controls use of the data" (DWBP Best Practice 4, quoted), and its test is whether a user agent can automatically detect or discover the licence (quoted). For federal public data assets an agency may satisfy the open-licence requirement by indicating, in its comprehensive data inventory, that the asset is in the public domain (M-25-05 §5(a)(v), quoted); the DCAT-US `license` field carries "the license or non-license (i.e. Public Domain) status" (quoted). No cited source requires the licence to be stated	DWBP's test is "Check if a user agent can automatically detect or discover the data license of the dataset", which reading the markup field and the Link header implements. The harness does not read the data inventory, where M-25-05 places the federal statement.	This data page's markup, its HTTP Link header, or the agency's recorded API terms page names a licence by a recognised identifier.	None of the places read names a licence by a recognised identifier: the page's markup, its Link header, and the API terms page only when an API terms address is recorded for the agency (when none is, that place was not read). It is not a claim that the data is unlicensed or restricted: federal data is generally public domain, and the agency's data inventory, where federal guidance says the status may be recorded, is not read by this check.	Nothing about the licence's terms, or about licences stated in page text or in the inventory.	**project_defined**. The pass and no-licence branches follow DWBP BP 4. The free-text branch fails a licence the harness itself detected, for a wording requirement no cited source makes (3 grid pages on the cycle of record rest on it). The check also omits the place federal guidance names, the inventory, so its no-licence claim

#	Check	Question	Expected behavior (source)	Test, and whether it is the recognized one	A pass claims	A fail claims	Neither claims	State
			as an identifier from a recognised list rather than in words; that requirement, in the free-text branch, is the project's own. Sources: `w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 4: Provide data license information; `m-25-05-phase-2-implementation-of-the-evidence-act-open-gove` §5(a)(v) Open License; `dcat-us-1-1-schema` license; `spdx-license-list` license identifiers.					is bounded to three other places.
13	**D4** `RULE-D4-v5`: Agency's data.json inventory lists this page, validly	Is the data product listed in the agency's public data inventory? Data.gov harvests agency inventories, and catalog-driven discovery (and SI clients that use catalogs to verify a source) find a product only if its record is there.	Each agency develops and maintains a comprehensive data inventory of all data assets it maintains (M-25-05, quoted), in the JSON format (quoted), conforming to the metadata schema approved by OMB on resources.data.gov (quoted), hosted at www.[agency].gov/data.json (quoted). When an agency disseminates a public data asset through the Federal Data Catalog, it includes in the inventory the URL or persistent identifier where the asset may be accessed (quoted). DCAT-US 1.1 defines the record's landingPage field for a dataset's human-friendly page (quoted). Sources: `m-25-05-phase-2-implementation-of-the-evidence-act-open-gove` §4(a) Comprehensive Data Inventories; §5(b)(ii); `dcat-us-1-1-schema` Dataset fields: identifier, landingPage, distribution.	Validating the catalog against the published JSON schema is the schema's own conformance test. No published method decides that a given web page is a given inventory record; matching its URL in the record's URL fields is this project's.	The agency's recorded inventory has a record that names this data page's address in identifier, landingPage, accessURL or downloadURL, and the inventory conforms to the federal metadata schema.	One of three things, named in the cell's reason: the recorded inventory was read and no record names this data page's address; or the page is listed but the inventory as a whole fails the schema (possibly in an unrelated record); or no inventory is served at any recorded address. It is not a claim that the dataset is missing from the inventory under another address (a record whose landing page differs from this page is not matched), nor that the agency has no inventory at an address not recorded for it (a parent department's, for example).	Nothing about the quality of the record, or about other catalogs.	**specified**. Each branch rewards or penalizes a behavior M-25-05 requires of federal agencies (a complete, schema-conforming inventory at data.json). The URL-match membership rule is a test property (DN-015 §4) and its false-negative mode is stated in the fail claim.
14	**F4** `RULE-F4-v5`: Change history served as a	Can a machine learn what changed between releases? An SI	The publisher provides a complete version history that explains the changes made in each version, so that humans and	DWBP's test is "Check that a list of published versions is available as well as a change log	A change history is served at a location recorded for the agency as a	No such feed was found at the recorded locations: there is no change history at them, or there is one	Nothing about revision notices in	**project_defined**. The pass and the no-changelog branches follow DWBP BP 8.

#	Check	Question	Expected behavior (source)	Test, and whether it is the recognized one	A pass claims	A fail claims	Neither claims	State
	structured feed	client holding last month's figure needs to know it was revised, and why; without a change history it cannot tell a revision from an error.	software agents can understand how versions differ (DWBP Best Practice 8); USAFacts asks for versioning that lets developers track updates. Neither requires the history in a feed format (JSON, Atom, RSS) or each entry to carry a revision class. Sources: `w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 8: Provide version history; `usafacts-ai-ready-data-guide` §1 Accessible.	describing precisely how each version differs". The harness checks for the change log at recorded locations, then adds a format and a classification requirement that test does not contain.	JSON, Atom or RSS feed, and at least half its entries say what kind of change they record.	published as a web page (9 of 23 data pages on the cycle of record), or its entries are unclassified, or the recorded locations were missing or wrong. The project's format and classification floors decide two of these; a precise HTML changelog that a machine can read and DWBP Best Practice 8 accepts still fails. A fail is not a claim that the version history is absent, incomplete or unreadable, nor that the agency does not publish revisions.	release text or methodology.	Two fail branches penalize behaviors no source requires (a history published as a page rather than a feed; entries without a change type). On the cycle of record 9 of the 18 grid-page fails on this check rest on the page branch.
15	**A11-declared** `RULE-A11-declared-v2` (a declaration)	What does the host declare about crawler access to the data page, in both places a declaration can live (robots.txt and the page's robots meta tag)? A declaration is the publisher's stated policy; it is half of the question whether crawlers are let in, and the half that can be read from outside.	This is a declaration check: it states what the host declares, and its expected behavior is the declaration's meaning. RFC 9309: the rules are not a form of access authorization (§1, quoted), and a robots.txt the server reports as unavailable lets the crawler access any resources (§2.3.1.3, quoted). Google: the robots meta tag's noindex rule applies to search engine crawlers, and such settings can be followed only if crawlers are allowed to access the pages that carry them (quoted). OpenAI: disallowing GPTBot means content should not be used in training, and allowing OAI-SearchBot helps a site appear in search results (quoted). Anthropic: restricting ClaudeBot signals exclusion from model training (quoted). Reading a training opt-out as a restriction	Parsing robots.txt per RFC 9309 and reading the meta tag as Google defines it are the declarations' own semantics.	Both the host's robots.txt and the page's robots meta tags, as declared, permit each of the eight listed crawler tokens.	One of three things, named in the reason: the robots.txt disallows a listed token (for five of the eight tokens that is a training opt-out, not a restriction on answers); the page's robots meta tags restrict it; or no robots.txt is served, which declares no restriction at all and under the standard permits every crawler. A fail is therefore not a claim that the agency declared a policy restricting crawler access. It is about declared policy only, not about whether any crawler is served or refused.	Nothing about enforcement (A12) or observed crawler traffic (agency-enabled).	**invalid**. Invalid by DN-015 §7: the reader answered no to question 1 in both rounds (its round-2 reason is recorded under reader_invalid). The defect it names is in this entry's quoting of its sources, not shown to be in the rule; before the reading, the writer's assessment was: state invalid. A declaration, reported as one. Two of its fail branches carry A4's defects (an absent robots.txt read as a restriction; training opt-outs read as access refusals), so as a readiness verdict it contradicts the

#	Check	Question	Expected behavior (source)	Test, and whether it is the recognized one	A pass claims	A fail claims	Neither claims	State
			on answers is not supported by these sources. Sources: `rfc-9309-robots-exclusion-protocol` §1; §2.3.1.3; https://developers.google.com/search/docs/crawling-indexing/robots-meta-tag Using the robots meta tag; `openai-crawlers-bots` GPTBot; OAI-SearchBot; `anthropic-crawler-support-article` ClaudeBot.					sources it cites. The meta-robots branch is sound.
16	**A12** `RULE-A12-v3`: Host serves the path its robots.txt permits	Does the host enforce what it declares? A host whose robots.txt permits an identified, compliant client and whose edge then refuses that client tells SI systems one thing and does another; the refusal, not the declaration, decides what they can read.	RFC 9309 separates the two layers: its rules are not a form of access authorization, and it is not a substitute for valid content security measures (§1, §3, quoted). It defines "unavailable": the server responds with a status indicating the robots.txt resource is unavailable, in HTTP the 400-499 range (quoted), and then the crawler MAY access any resources on the server (quoted). No cited source states that a publisher's enforcement should agree with its declaration; that coherence is this project's construct. Sources: none.	None published for declaration–enforcement coherence; the paired request is this project's.	The host's robots.txt permits this scanner on the data page's path, and the host served the path to it.	One of three things, named in the reason: the host answered a refusal status (401, 403 or 429) to this scanner's request for /robots.txt; robots.txt permits the scanner on the path and the host answered a refusal status for that path; or no robots.txt is served, which under RFC 9309 declares permission and involves no contradiction (the page may have been served). Only the second is a host doing other than it declares, and a 429 among those statuses is a rate limit that may be transient rather than a policy. A transient error or server failure is never a fail here. It is a claim about one identified client, not about every crawler.	Nothing about other clients, including browsers and named answer-engine crawlers.	**invalid**. The coherence construct has no published definition, and one fail branch reads a missing robots.txt as "nothing declared" where RFC 9309 reads it as permission. The refusal it records is real and is already recorded as the `refused` error class on every other check.

Branches, confounds and fix lines

Each rule's verdict branches, with the behavior each rewards or penalizes, its source and its state (DN-015 §2). A check's state is its weakest branch's (DN-015 §3).

A13 `RULE-A13-v1`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_a13.py`. Client: the harness's identified, robots-compliant client (params.manners.user_agent); no request of its own: it consumes Observations other legs made (CONSUMES = link_probe, A2, D1, F4, D4). Request: none new; the product page fetch of the shared link probe (its link set and response headers) and the A2, D1, F4, D4 fetches of the body's recorded locations. Reads: the product page's hrefs and Link header; the recorded location of each object and whether it was served.

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
pass_every_object_reachable	pass	every object shown to exist is reached, by a link (project-defined) or a convention address (published); the surface pass can rest on the link branch alone	none	project_defined
fail_any_object_unreachable	fail	any one object, including the API's terms or the changelog, is neither linked nor at a convention address; rests on the project's composite and on per-object fails of which none is fully published	none	project_defined

Not measured: per-object `error`: existence not settled (a recorded location unverified, seed sources not searched), the page not served or its links not read, or the api-catalog location not fetched (no collector fetches it yet, so the API's convention branch is `error` wherever the API is not linked)

Confounds:

- the object is linked from a different page (a developer page, a site footer) rather than this data page. Distinguished: no: the harness reads one page's links; a reader cannot tell 'unreachable' from 'reachable elsewhere'.
- the api-catalog location was never fetched. Distinguished: yes: the API's convention branch returns error 'was not fetched', not fail.
- the recorded location of the object is wrong or stale. Distinguished: partly: a recorded location that answered 404/410 counts as no object; a seeded but unverified location is error.

Fix line: none (not a grid column).

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. The /.well-known/api-catalog convention and the data.json address are supported by the quotes. But the expected behavior states, as RFC 9727's requirement, that the publisher may alternatively 'send a Link header with rel="api-catalog"'. The quoted §3 passage only says the relation 'identifies a target resource that represents a list of APIs'; it does not mention a Link header, and the §2 quote makes the well-known URI mandatory ('SHALL resolve'), so the either/or framing is the writer's, not the source's. 'Comprehensive' is also not in the M-25-05 quote. The terms/changelog/hyperlink gaps are correctly declared undefined.
- Round 2 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source yes; misreading yes; undefined terms no. Each requirement the expected-behavior text attributes to a source has a matching quoted passage: the GET to /.well-known/api-catalog returning an API catalog document (RFC 9727 'SHALL resolve an HTTPS GET request…'), the optional api-catalog link relation in header or content (RFC 9727 'could include the api-catalog link relation in the HTTP header and/or content payload'), and the inventory at www.[agency].gov/data.json (M-25-05 'each agency must post the inventory … to www.[agency].gov/data.json'). The parts no source defines (reaching the API's terms or changelog, and an ordinary hyperlink from a data page as the discovery mechanism) are stated plainly as the project's own.
- The entry was revised after its last reading (its claims or terms, from the reader's answers to questions 2 and 3); that revision has not been read.

A2 `RULE-A2-v6`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_a2_v6.py`. Client: the harness's identified, robots-compliant client (params.manners.user_agent), one request per second per host; it never fetches a path robots.txt disallows for it. Request: GET the API base recorded for the agency in targets.yaml declared_locations (read from the agency's own pages, or seeded from a named source) and any description document recorded beside it. Reads: whether the response is a document carrying the `openapi` field (OpenAPI 3.x) or the `swagger` field (Swagger 2.0).

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
pass_openapi_at_recorded_locatipass		an OpenAPI or Swagger description is served where the API is recorded	`openapi-specification-core` §4.1.1; `w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 25	specified

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
fail_json_at_base_not_openapi	fail	the API exists and its base serves JSON that is not OpenAPI/ Swagger; penalizes a description in another format, or one published elsewhere (a developer page, a catalog), which no source forbids	none	project_defined
fail_no_description_found	fail	no OpenAPI or Swagger document at any recorded API location, or no API recorded for the agency at all; reads 'no documented API' though only OpenAPI at recorded addresses was looked for	none	project_defined

Not measured: `robots_disallowed` (the scanner's robots compliance kept it from the recorded address), `refused` (401/403/429 to the identified client), or a recorded location not verified / a seed source not searched

Confounds:

- the agency documents its API in human-readable pages or in a non-OpenAPI machine format (for example a DCAT discovery document at the API root). Distinguished: no: both are fail on this check, indistinguishable from an undocumented API in the cell.
- the description is published at a developer page or a catalog, not the recorded base. Distinguished: no, unless that address is the recorded location.
- the host's firewall refuses the identified client. Distinguished: yes: `refused`, an error, never fail.
- robots.txt disallows the recorded address for the scanner. Distinguished: yes: `robots_disallowed`, an error, never fail.
- the API requires a key. Distinguished: not tested: the harness does not call the API.

Fix line (`act:a2-expose-an-api-and-publish-its-description`): rewritten from "Expose the product through a machine interface and publish its description." to "Publish a machine-readable description of the data interface where the interface is served.". The old line tells an agency with an API to expose one; the expected behavior (DWBP BP 25, RFC 9727 §4.1) is a description where the API is served.

What this entry settles:

- **search engine location is not the behavior**: Whether a search engine can find an agency's API is not what this check measures and not what it claims. The check asks whether a description document is served at the recorded API address. An API that every search engine indexes can fail it; an API no search engine has seen can pass it.
- **dataset search depends on markup**: Google's Dataset Search finds datasets through schema.org Dataset markup, or equivalent W3C DCAT structures, on the pages that describe them (google-dataset-structured-data, "Our approach to dataset discovery": "We can understand structured data in web pages about datasets, using either schema.org Dataset markup, or equivalent structures represented in W3C's Data Catalog Vocabulary (DCAT) format"). That is the A6 check's construct, on the data page; it is not what this check reads, and an OpenAPI description does not enter Dataset Search.
- **robots is declared policy firewall is enforcement**: robots.txt is a declaration: "These rules are not a form of access authorization" (RFC 9309 §1), and the protocol "is not a substitute for valid content security measures" (§3). A host that answers 403 to an identified client is enforcing, at the edge, whatever its robots.txt says. They are two observations. The harness records them separately: a path robots.txt disallows for the scanner is never requested and is recorded `robots_disallowed`; a 401, 403 or 429 on a permitted path is recorded `refused` (errors.py); both are `error` on this check, never fail. On the cycle of record 7 of the 23 data pages returned `robots_disallowed` here and 1 returned `refused`.
- **data page not api endpoint**: The harness measures what a client meets at the data page and the recorded API address with one identified client. It does not call the API's data endpoints, and it does not test whether a script calling the API with or without a key is refused. No cell of this check says anything about whether the API serves scripts.

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. Three requirements are attributed to sources the quoted passages do not support. (1) 'builds the API on Web standards (Best Practice 24)': no passage from BP 24 is quoted at all. (2) 'documents every call, its parameters and what it returns' is attributed to BP 25, but the only BP 25 passage quoted says 'Provide complete information on the Web about your API'; the call/parameter/return detail is the writer's gloss (the BP 25 test text appears only in the TEST section, not among the quoted passages). (3) 'reachable from the catalog or available at the API endpoint URIs it lists' is attributed to RFC 9727 §4.1, but the quoted passage covers only availability at the listed endpoint URIs ('they SHOULD make that metadata available at the API endpoint URIs they have listed'), not reachability from the catalog, and speaks of 'metadata', not a description. The OAS quote supports the discover-and-understand sentence, and the closing sentence plainly states what no source requires, which is correct practice; the `openapi`/`swagger` REQUIRED fields are cited but not quoted, though the expected-behavior text does not itself assert them as a requirement.
- Round 2 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. Nearly every attribution is backed by a quoted passage: DWBP's 'complete information on the Web', its How-to-Test wording on calls/parameters/returns, its 'enables machines' outcome, OAS's 'humans and computers' purpose, and both RFC 9727 clauses (RECOMMENDED OpenAPI links; SHOULD make metadata available at listed endpoint URIs). The project's own additions (OpenAPI-only, at the recorded base) are stated plainly as the project's own. One attributed claim is not in the passages: that the `openapi` field is 'required' by OAS. The quoted OAS text only says the string MUST be the version number; 'REQUIRED' appears solely in the writer's citation label for §4.1.1, not in any verbatim quote. Since the pass branch rests on presence of that field, the requiredness is a source claim that should be quoted.

A1 `RULE-A1-v5`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_a1_v5.py`. Client: the harness's identified, robots-compliant client; HEAD per link (GET on 405/501), one request per second per host. Request: GET the data page; HEAD every link on it whose host is the page's own host (params.link_probe: same_host_only true), up to a cap of 25; a search that left candidates unprobed returns error, not fail. Reads: each linked response's Content-Type, and the href's extension.

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
pass_structured_served	pass	the data page links a file served with a structured data media type	`w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 12; `usafacts-ai-ready-data-guide` §1	specified
fail_only_pdf	fail	the only data documents linked from the page are PDFs	`usafacts-ai-ready-data-guide` §1 (avoid PDFs that need to be processed and parsed); `w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 12	specified
fail_no_structured_link	fail	no link on the page, on its own host, serves a structured data format	`w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 12	specified

Not measured: the page refused (`refused`) or kept from the scanner by robots.txt (`robots_disallowed`); every link unobserved; more on-host links than the cap of 25, so the absence is unconfirmed (`absence not established`): 19 of the 23 data pages on the cycle of record, 15 of them an unconfirmed absence

Confounds:

- the data is on another host (for example data.census.gov, api.bls.gov) and the page links there. Distinguished: no: off-host links are outside the probe's scope and do not count; a fail stands.
- the page has more on-host links than the probe cap. Distinguished: yes: error `absence not established`, never fail.
- the server declares a wrong media type for a real data file (for example application/octet-stream). Distinguished: partly: the href extension is also read; an extensionless file with a generic type is missed.
- the firewall refuses the client, or robots.txt disallows it. Distinguished: yes: error.

Fix line (`act:a1-serve-the-data-files-with-their-own-media-type`): "Link a data file from the product page and serve it with its own media type.", consistent with the expected behavior.

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. Two of the three attributions are supported: the W3C passage backs 'machine-readable, standardized data format', the M-25-05 passage backs the quoted definition of machine-readable, and the USAFacts passage backs the format list and the PDF exclusion. But the sentence 'For federal public data assets this is required', attributed to M-25-05 §5(a)(i), has no quoted passage: the only M-25-05 quote is the definition, and the §5(a)(i) 'agencies must make each of their public data assets machine-readable' text appears only as the writer's paraphrase in the Established-by line, not in the verbatim passages. The 'quoting the Evidence Act' attribution is likewise unquoted. The project's own choices (the media-type list, the 25-link cap) are correctly labeled as chosen by this project.
- Round 2 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source yes; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. Each requirement the expected-behavior text attributes to a source is matched by a quoted passage: the DWBP 'machine-readable, standardized data format' wording, the M-25-05 'Agencies must make each of their public data assets machine-readable' mandate and its 'easily processed by a computer without human intervention' definition, and USAFacts' JSON/CSV/machine-readable Excel list with the instruction to avoid PDFs. The one element no source defines, the concrete list of structured media types (text/csv, application/json, geo+json, parquet, xls/xlsx, xml), is stated plainly as 'chosen by this project'.
- The entry was revised after its last reading (its claims or terms, from the reader's answers to questions 2 and 3); that revision has not been read.

A3 `RULE-A3-v8`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_a3_v8.py`. Client: the harness's identified, robots-compliant client; HEAD per link, same host only, cap 25. Request: GET the data page; HEAD each on-host link. Reads: each linked response's Content-Type, Content-Length, extension, and whether the URL carries a query string.

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
pass_archive_or_large_file	pass	the page links an archive or a large unfiltered file, the observable form of a bulk download	`w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 17	specified

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
fail_only_filtered_queries	fail	the only downloads are query-filtered extracts, not the full dataset in one request	`w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 17	specified
fail_below_floor	fail	the largest linked file is smaller than the floor, read as not the full dataset	`w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 17	specified
fail_no_download	fail	no download of any kind is linked from the page on its own host	`w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 17	specified

Not measured: refused, robots_disallowed, every link unobserved, or more on-host links than the cap (`absence not established`): 17 of 23 data pages on the cycle of record

Confounds:

- a small product whose complete file is under 50 KiB. Distinguished: no: a fail on the floor branch; the reason names the floor so a reader can see it.
- a large file that is one table of many (a pass that is not the full dataset). Distinguished: no.
- bulk files offered on another host. Distinguished: no: off-host links are out of scope.
- more on-host links than the cap; refusal; robots. Distinguished: yes: error.

Fix line (`act:a3-link-a-bulk-download-from-the-product-page`): "Link a bulk download of the product from the product page.", consistent with the expected behavior.

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. The DWBP sentence is quoted verbatim and supported. The M-23-22 requirement is not: the expected behavior states it as 'where there is public interest in scraping an agency's pages, the agency should make the information available … in bulk', but the quoted passage is only the fragment 'making that information available as machine-readable data that can be accessed in bulk'. The scraping-interest condition and the 'should' obligation are the writer's addition, not shown in any passage. The dcat-us-1-1-schema source is also listed with no quoted passage, though the expected-behavior text attributes no requirement to it. The project does say plainly that the size-floor and archive proxy are its own.
- Round 2 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source yes; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. Both requirements the expected-behavior text attributes to a source are backed by a quoted passage: the DWBP sentence is quoted verbatim, and the M-23-22 sentence is a near-verbatim rendering of the third quoted passage (only 'its web pages'/'it should' differ from 'web pages'/'the agency should'). The size floor and the archive/unfiltered-file proxy are stated plainly as this project's own ('chosen by this project'; 'The proxy is this project's; no published method exists'). The only unsupported attribution is in the QUESTION block, not the expected behavior: the usafacts guide is said to call for 'RESTful APIs for real-time and bulk retrieval' with no quoted passage, so that citation is unverified here.
- The entry was revised after its last reading (its claims or terms, from the reader's answers to questions 2 and 3); that revision has not been read.

A4 `RULE-A4-v1`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_a4.py`. Client: the harness's identified client; GET /robots.txt once per host. Request: GET https:///robots.txt, parsed with protego. Reads: for each of eight user-agent tokens, whether the rules allow the data page's path.

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
pass_all_listed_allowed	pass	the declared policy permits every listed token on the data path	`rfc-9309-robots-exclusion-protocol` §2.2	specified
fail_no_robots_txt	fail	penalizes serving no robots.txt; under RFC 9309 §2.3.1.3 that permits every crawler, so the check's own construct (crawlers allowed) is met while the cell reads fail. M-23-22 asks agencies to use robots.txt, which is a different construct (declaration practice)	`rfc-9309-robots-exclusion-protocol` §2.3.1.3 (contradicts the branch)	invalid
fail_some_token_disallowed	fail	penalizes disallowing any listed token, five of which (GPTBot, ClaudeBot, Google-Extended, CCBot, Applebot-Extended) their vendors define as training opt-outs, not as exclusion from answers	`openai-crawlers-bots` GPTBot (contradicts the branch); `anthropic-crawler-support-article` ClaudeBot (contradicts the branch); `google-ai-`	invalid

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
			`features-and-your-website` Google-Extended (contradicts the branch)	

Not measured: robots.txt could not be observed (the host refused the client: 3 of 16 hosts on the cycle of record)

Confounds:

- the host blocks crawlers at a firewall or CDN while robots.txt permits them. Distinguished: no: this check passes; the refusal is A12's observation.
- the host opts out of training crawlers only, while permitting search crawlers. Distinguished: no: fail, indistinguishable in the cell from a host that blocks answer engines.
- no robots.txt at all. Distinguished: no: fail, though the standard reads it as permission.

Fix line (`act:a4-serve-a-robots-txt-that-names-ai-crawlers`): "Serve a robots.txt that permits the data paths for the crawlers you want to allow.", consistent with the expected behavior. Consistent with M-23-22's robots.txt practice; it does not respond to a readiness failure under RFC 9309, and the check is off page two (state invalid).

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading no; undefined terms yes. Several statements attributed to sources have no supporting quoted passage. (a) 'rules are matched per user-agent product token (§2.2)' is attributed to RFC 9309 but no §2.2 passage is quoted; only §2.3.1.3 and §1 are. (b) 'Googlebot governs Search and its AI features (Google)' rests on a quote that names neither Googlebot nor AI features; the passage says only that something 'is the control … for Search'. (c) The RFC quote supports 'MAY access any resources' but not the '(a 4xx)' gloss. (d) CCBot is listed among crawlers whose use 'is defined by each vendor' as training or grounding, yet no Common Crawl source is cited or quoted. (e) 'A ready publisher permits the crawlers of the answer engines it wants to be read by' is presented without attribution and is not plainly marked as the project's own construct, though the final clause about training crawlers is correctly flagged as undefined by any source.
- Round 2 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source yes; misreading no; undefined terms yes. Each requirement attributed to a source matches a quoted passage: RFC 9309 case-insensitive group matching (§2.2 quote), 400-499 status and 'MAY access any resources' (§2.3.1.3 quotes), 'not a form of access authorization' (§1 quote); Google's Googlebot-as-control and Google-Extended-for-training-and-grounding (both quoted); OpenAI's GPTBot training opt-out and OAI-SearchBot recommendation (both quoted); Anthropic's ClaudeBot training-exclusion signal (quoted). CCBot is stated plainly to have no source, the absence of any readiness requirement is stated, and the project's own reading is marked as its own. The only gloss beyond the quotes is the word 'ChatGPT' before 'search results' in the OpenAI sentence; the quote says only 'search results'. That names the vendor's own search rather than adding a requirement, so it does not make the expected behavior the writer's.

A5 `RULE-A5-v2`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_a5_v2.py`. Client: the harness's identified, robots-compliant client. Request: GET /sitemap.xml, /sitemap_index.xml, the sitemap(s) robots.txt declares (same site only), /llms.txt and /.well-known/ discovery paths; parse sitemaps with ultimate-sitemap-parser. Reads: whether any served sitemap lists the data page's URL.

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
pass_listed_in_sitemap	pass	a sitemap served on the host lists the data page	`omb-m-23-22-digital-first-public-experience` §III.4; `sitemaps-protocol` protocol	specified
fail_served_but_not_listed	fail	the host serves a sitemap or llms.txt that does not list the data page	`omb-m-23-22-digital-first-public-experience` §III.4; https://developers.google.com/search/docs/crawling-indexing/sitemaps/overview Do I need a sitemap?	specified
fail_no_discovery_file	fail	the host serves no sitemap at the probed locations	`omb-m-23-22-digital-first-public-experience` §III.4	specified

Not measured: every discovery probe refused or unobserved (3 of 16 hosts on the cycle of record), or a probe unobserved while none found the page

Confounds:

- the sitemap lists the page under a different URL form (trailing slash, redirect target, query string). Distinguished: no: a fail.

- the only discovery file served is llms.txt, which by its proposal summarises a site rather than listing every page. Distinguished: no: the served-but-not-listed branch does not separate llms.txt from a sitemap in its verdict, only in its reason's URLs.
- the sitemap is declared on another site. Distinguished: yes: not_applicable.

Fix line (`act:a5-list-the-product-url-in-the-sitemap`): "List the product address in the discovery file that is already served.", consistent with the expected behavior.

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. Two attributions outrun the quoted passages. (a) The entry says the sitemaps protocol defines the sitemap's 'declaration in robots.txt' and its scope as 'on one host'; the only sitemaps-protocol quote is 'The location of a Sitemap file determines the set of URLs that can be included in that Sitemap', which supports a location-bound scope but says nothing about robots.txt declaration or a single-host limit (the robots.txt section is named in 'Cited sources' but never quoted). (b) The entry says Google 'states that a large site benefits from a sitemap that lists the pages the owner wants found, and that a small, comprehensively linked site may not need one'; the Google quotes are only the truncated 'You might not need a sitemap if' and 'in most cases, your site will benefit from having a sitemap', which contain no large/small-site conditions, no 'comprehensively linked' condition, and nothing about listing the pages the owner wants found. The M-23-22 attribution is supported. The entry does not mark the unsupported parts as the project's own.
- Round 2 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source yes; misreading no; undefined terms yes. Each attributed requirement maps to a quoted passage: the M-23-22 'best practices … including using sitemaps' sentence; the protocol's location-bounds-URLs, robots.txt declaration, and single-host passages; Google's 'which pages and files you think are important', the 'about 500 pages or fewer' and 'comprehensively linked' conditions, and the large-site linking difficulty. The one premise no source supplies (that a data page is among the pages the owner thinks important) is explicitly labelled the framework's own. The only looseness is that the writer joins Google's separate 'small' and 'comprehensively linked' bullets with 'that is', which the passages neither confirm nor contradict as conjunctive; it does not add a requirement.

A6 `RULE-A6-v2`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_a6_v2.py`. Client: the harness's identified, robots-compliant client; one GET of the data page; no JavaScript executed. Request: GET the data page; extract JSON-LD, Microdata and RDFa with extruct. Reads: the types declared, and a SHACL validation of the graph against shapes/dcat_ap_min.ttl (schema:Dataset needs name and description; dcat:Dataset needs dct:title and dct:description; dcat:Distribution needs dcat:accessURL).

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
pass_dataset_conforms	pass	Dataset markup with the required properties	`google-dataset-structured-data` Required properties	specified
fail_markup_without_dataset_type	fail	the page carries markup that does not declare a dataset	`google-dataset-structured-data` Our approach to dataset discovery	specified
fail_no_markup	fail	the page carries no structured markup at all	`google-dataset-structured-data` Our approach to dataset discovery	specified
fail_shapes_violated	fail	Dataset markup lacking a required property	`google-dataset-structured-data` Required properties	specified

Not measured: refused, robots_disallowed, or markup declared but the graph could not be loaded for validation (4 of 23 data pages on the cycle of record)

Confounds:

- markup injected by JavaScript after load. Distinguished: no: the harness does not render; a fail.
- the dataset is described on a catalog or landing page other than this data page. Distinguished: no: one page is read.
- a DataCatalog type with no Dataset in the graph. Distinguished: no: the shapes target Dataset and Distribution only, so a DataCatalog alone passes unvalidated.

Fix line (`act:a6-type-the-product-page-as-a-dataset`): "Type the product page's existing markup as a dataset.", consistent with the expected behavior.

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. Three parts of the expected behavior are attributed to sources with no supporting quoted passage. (a) 'Schema.org defines the Dataset type' cites schema-org-dataset, but no passage from that source is quoted at all. (b) 'DCAT 3 defines dcat:Dataset with dct:title and dct:description' cites w3c-dcat-3, but no passage from that source is quoted; the only DCAT mention is Google's phrase 'or equivalent structures represented in W3C's Data Catalog Vocabulary (DCAT) format', which says nothing about title or description. (c) 'in JSON-LD, RDFa or Microdata' is stated as part of the sourced requirement, but no passage names any serialization format. The claim that Google's required properties are name and description is only indirectly supported: the

quoted passages give a 'required properties' sentence plus two property glosses ('A short summary describing a dataset', 'A descriptive name of a dataset') without naming the properties or saying they are the required ones. None of these gaps is marked as the project's own.

- Round 2 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. Most of the expected behavior is backed by passages: the recommendation to add structured data to canonical pages, the DCAT equivalence, the eligibility requirement, the description and name property texts, and the schema.org definition. But the text attributes to Google, marked '(quoted)', that markup is read 'in JSON-LD (preferred), RDFa or Microdata'. No passage mentions JSON-LD or any preference; the only syntax passage says the schema.org vocabulary 'can also be used in RDFa 1.1 or Microdata syntaxes', which implies an unnamed primary syntax but does not name it or call it preferred. Secondarily, 'name' is quoted only as 'A descriptive name of a dataset.'; the passages show only description under the 'Required properties' heading, so name's status as required is asserted rather than shown.

A8 `RULE-A8-v4`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_a8_v4.py`. Client: the harness's identified, robots-compliant client. Request: GET the data page; follow up to three same-host latest-version pointers (link rel latest-version/last/canonical, hrefs with /latest or /current, anchors reading latest or most recent). Reads: markup fields dateModified, datePublished, temporalCoverage; the Last-Modified header; each pointer's status.

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
pass_dated_and_latest_resolves	pass	a machine-readable release date and a resolving latest-version link	`w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 7; Best Practice 11	specified
pass_via_temporal_coverage	pass	credits the period the data covers as if it were a release date	none	project_defined
fail_only_last_modified	fail	the only date is the server's representation timestamp	https://www.rfc-editor.org/rfc/rfc9110.txt §8.8.2; `w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 7	specified
fail_no_date	fail	no machine-readable date at all	`w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 7	specified
fail_no_or_broken_latest_pointer	fail	dated, but no resolving latest-version link on the host	`w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 11	specified

Not measured: refused or robots_disallowed (4 of 23 data pages), or a latest pointer that was not observed

Confounds:

- the date is in visible text or a table caption, not in markup. Distinguished: no: a fail.
- the date is in the agency's data.json record (DCAT-US modified). Distinguished: no: the inventory is not read by this check.
- a pass resting on temporalCoverage. Distinguished: yes, in the reason (the field is named); the branch is project_defined.

Fix line (`act:a8-publish-a-release-date-for-the-product`): rewritten from "Publish a release date for the product." to "Publish the product's release date in the page's structured markup.". DWBP BP 7's test is that a computer application can detect the date; the old line is satisfied by a date in prose, which this check does not read.

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. The expected behavior attributes to DCAT-US a field name and definition (modified, "Most recent date on which the dataset was changed"), but no quoted passage from dcat-us-1-1-schema appears; that requirement rests on the writer's citation alone. Secondarily, the claim that the series has a URI for 'the latest version' (Best Practice 11) is only partly supported: the quoted passage says agents will be able to refer to 'the latest version', but the word URI appears only in the writer's title line for BP 11, not in any quoted passage. BP 7 (version number or date, machine-detectable) and the RFC 9110 Last-Modified description are supported by the quotes.
- Round 2 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source yes; misreading no; undefined terms yes. Each requirement the expected-behavior text attributes to a source is backed by a quoted passage: a detectable version number or date (DWBP 'Assign and indicate a version number or date' and the 'Check if a computer application can automatically detect' test), URIs for versions and series enabling 'the latest version' (DWBP 'Assign URIs to individual versions… overall series' and the 'software agents will be able to refer to… the latest version' passage), the DCAT-US modified definition (quoted verbatim), and the RFC 9110 Last-Modified definition (quoted verbatim). The contrast 'not the release the data belongs to' is an inference from the RFC quote rather than a requirement, and the parts no source defines, the resolving latest-version pointer test and the temporalCoverage branch, are stated plainly as this project's own ('No published test exists… is this project's'; branch 'Source: none', 'project_defined'). The only loose end is the label 'Last Update', which appears in the citation descriptor rather than a quoted passage, but it names the field rather than adding a requirement.

A9 `RULE-A9-v2`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_a9_v2.py`. Client: the harness's identified, robots-compliant client. Request: GET a fixed set of probe paths: the recorded API base and its description, /.well-known/mcp, /llms.txt. Reads: status, Content-Type, body length.

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
pass_any_non_html_2xx	pass	any probe returns non-HTML content (any JSON at the API base, any llms.txt)	none	project_defined
fail_html_only	fail	the probed addresses answer with HTML	none	project_defined
fail_none_served	fail	none of the probed addresses is served	none	project_defined

Not measured: refused, robots_disallowed, or the recorded API base not probed (15 of 23 data pages on the cycle of record)

Confounds:

- the API base returns any JSON at all (an error message, a catalog). Distinguished: no: it passes.
- the agency publishes its machine entry point at an address outside the probe set. Distinguished: no.

Fix line (`act:a9-publish-a-machine-first-entry-point`): "Publish a machine-first entry point for the product.", consistent with the expected behavior. Consistent with the check, which is itself project_defined; the line names no published target.

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source yes; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. The EXPECTED BEHAVIOR attributes no requirement to any source: it says plainly that no published standard defines a machine-first entry point or its address set, labels OAS a specification and llms.txt a proposal, and says /.well-known/mcp has no source in the corpus; 'Cited sources: none' and the empty passage list match this. One tension to note: the QUESTION's 'Established by' line names llmstxt-proposal and FAIR A1 as establishing the check, yet no passage is quoted for either and the expected-behavior text disowns them, so that line is unsupported, but it is not stated as a source requirement inside the expected behavior.
- The entry was revised after its last reading (its claims or terms, from the reader's answers to questions 2 and 3); that revision has not been read.

A10 `RULE-A10-v3`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_a10_v3.py`. Client: the harness's identified, robots-compliant client; no renderer (params.a10_soft404.renderer: none). Request: GET the tool's deep link; GET the same tool with the suffix /**ai-readiness-kg-probe-404**. Reads: both statuses; error-shell tokens in the invalid route's body; visible characters in the deep link before JavaScript.

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
fail_soft_404	fail	HTTP 200 for a route that does not exist	https://www.rfc-editor.org/rfc/rfc9110.txt §15.5.5; https://developers.google.com/crawling/docs/troubleshooting/http-status-codes soft 404	specified
fail_deep_link_error	fail	the product's own deep link is not served	https://www.rfc-editor.org/rfc/rfc9110.txt §15 status codes	specified
fail_client_rendered_shell	fail	penalizes a tool whose content arrives by JavaScript; the cited crawler documentation supports that model	none	project_defined
pass_all_three	pass	real 404, served deep link, and at least 2000 visible characters before JavaScript; the last condition has no source	none	project_defined

Not measured: refused (3 of 16 hosts on the cycle of record), or either probe unobserved

Confounds:

- a tool built as a single-page application that renders correctly in a browser and in Googlebot. Distinguished: no: the shell branch fails it.
- a soft 404 served by a CDN or framework default rather than the agency's choice. Distinguished: no; it is still what a client receives.

Fix line (`act:a10-return-a-real-status-for-routes-that-do-not-exist`): "Return a real status for routes that do not exist.", consistent with the expected behavior.

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source yes; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. The two requirements the text attributes to sources are backed by quoted passages: the 404 definition is the verbatim RFC 9110 §15.5.5 sentence, and 'a 200 whose content says the page is an error is a soft 404 which Google treats as an error' is supported by 'Search Console will show a soft 404 error'. The deep-link-served requirement is not attributed to any source in the text. The pre-JavaScript content requirement is said plainly to have no cited source and the 2000-character floor is marked 'chosen by this project', with the branches table repeating 'Source: none'. Two small assertions go beyond the quoted passages but are not stated as source requirements: the '(or 410)' alternative is not in the RFC quote, and 'the app-shell model it describes is supported' is not in the Google quote (which only says 200 pages are queued for rendering); both are used to loosen, not tighten, what is demanded.
- The entry was revised after its last reading (its claims or terms, from the reader's answers to questions 2 and 3); that revision has not been read.

B3 `RULE-B3-v4`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_b3_v4.py`. Client: the harness's identified, robots-compliant client; no renderer. Request: GET the data page; follow every link whose address or anchor text contains the token `methodolog` (up to 25). Reads: each followed document's Content-Type, visible characters before JavaScript, and link density.

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
pass_html_methodology	pass	a methodology document in HTML or text, readable without running scripts; the HTML part is M-23-22's and the without-scripts part is the project's reading	none	project_defined
fail_no_methodology_link	fail	the data page links no document whose address or text says methodology	`usafacts-ai-ready-data-guide` §2 heading (Easily Retrievable documentation)	specified
fail_thin_or_navigation	fail	penalizes a methodology page with too little text before scripts run, or mostly links; no source asks for content before scripts	none	project_defined
fail_pdf_only	fail	the methodology is published only as a PDF	`omb-m-23-22-digital-first-public-experience` §III.9.b Default to HTML	specified
fail_no_structured_text	fail	followed methodology links lead to nothing readable as text	`usafacts-ai-ready-data-guide` §4	specified

Not measured: refused or robots_disallowed (4 of 23 data pages on the cycle of record), or methodology links left unfollowed

Confounds:

- the methodology is linked under another name (technical documentation, survey design, about the data). Distinguished: no: the token predicate misses it and the no-link branch fails (12 of 23 data pages on the cycle of record took that branch).
- a methodology hub page that is mostly links to chapters. Distinguished: partly: the link-density ceiling fails it as navigation.
- refusal, robots. Distinguished: yes: error.

Fix line (`act:b3-link-the-methodology-from-the-product-page`): "Link the methodology from the product page.", consistent with the expected behavior.

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. The HTML half is supported: the M-23-22 passage says non-HTML content only when a specific user need necessitates it, which matches 'publishes documents in HTML unless a specific user need requires another format'. The USAFacts half is partly unsupported: the quoted passages support 'accessible to both humans and web crawlers' (§4) and that models need collection methodology as context (§2), but no quoted passage says methodology must be 'easily retrievable'. That phrase is attributed to USAFacts §2 in both the expected behavior and the fail_no_methodology_link branch ('§2 (easily retrievable documentation)'), yet it appears in neither quoted passage; nor is the 'disclose methodologies' wording the QUESTION attributes to §2 quoted. The 'readable without running scripts' element is not attributed to a source in the expected-behavior text, and the test section says the token and thresholds are the project's own, which is stated plainly.
- Round 2 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source yes; misreading no; undefined terms yes. Every requirement the expected-behavior text attributes to a source has a matching quoted passage: the 'Machine Understandable with Easily Retrievable' heading, 'AI models need context… collection methodology', 'Disclose methodologies for derived or transformed datasets', 'accessible to both humans and AI/web crawlers', and M-23-22's

'non-HTML format only if necessitated by a specific user need'. The one requirement no passage supports, readability without running scripts, is stated plainly as the project's own reading with 'no source states it', and the 2000-character and 0.25 link-density thresholds are declared as chosen by the project in the test field rather than attributed to a source.
- The entry was revised after its last reading (its claims or terms, from the reader's answers to questions 2 and 3); that revision has not been read.

D1 `RULE-D1-v6`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_d1_v6.py`. Client: the harness's identified, robots-compliant client. Request: GET the data page; read its markup license field and any HTTP Link header; GET the API terms page at its recorded location when an API is recorded. Reads: whether any of the three carries a recognised licence identifier (Creative Commons, SPDX, opensource.org, usa.gov/government-works, opendefinition.org URLs; tokens CC0, CC-BY, PUBLIC DOMAIN, U.S. GOVERNMENT WORK, MIT, APACHE-2.0, ODC-BY).

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
pass_recognised_identifier	pass	a machine-detectable licence statement naming a recognised licence	`w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 4	specified
fail_free_text	fail	penalizes a licence the harness detected but that is worded rather than identified; DWBP BP 4 asks only that it be detectable	none	project_defined
fail_no_licence	fail	no licence statement in the page's markup, Link header or recorded API terms	`w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 4	specified

Not measured: refused or robots_disallowed (5 of 23 data pages), or the API-terms source not settled (2)

Confounds:

- the licence or public-domain status is stated in the data.json inventory record. Distinguished: no: not read.
- a licence stated in visible page text or a footer link without rel=license. Distinguished: no: a fail.
- a worded licence ('Public data, free to use'). Distinguished: yes in the reason (free-text branch), no in the cell.

Fix line (`act:d1-publish-a-machine-readable-licence`): rewritten from "Publish a machine-readable licence for the product." to "State the product's licence or public domain status in its machine-readable metadata.". M-25-05 lets a federal agency satisfy the requirement by indicating public domain status; the old line implies a licence must be adopted.

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. The first sentence attributes to DWBP Best Practice 4 that 'the publisher provides a link to or copy of the licence', but the only DWBP passage quoted is the test ('Check if a user agent can automatically detect or discover the data license of the dataset'); nothing quoted mentions a link or a copy. The M-25-05 and DCAT-US statements are supported by their passages (with a small stretch: M-25-05 says agencies 'may satisfy' the requirement via the inventory, the entry says the status 'is indicated' there), and the recognised-identifier requirement is plainly marked as no source's. The unsupported 'link to or copy of' clause is the defect.
- Round 2 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source yes; misreading no; undefined terms yes. Each requirement the expected-behavior text attributes to a source is backed by a quoted passage: the DWBP 'provide a link to or copy of the license agreement' and its 'automatically detect or discover' test, the M-25-05 statement that the inventory may indicate public-domain status, and the DCAT-US 'license or non-license (i.e. Public Domain) status' field. The one requirement no source supports, that the licence be a recognised identifier rather than words, is stated plainly as the project's own, and the free-text branch lists its source as none. The spdx-license-list and usafacts citations carry no quoted passage, but the expected-behavior text attributes no requirement to them.

D4 `RULE-D4-v5`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_d4_v5.py`. Client: the harness's identified, robots-compliant client. Request: GET the inventory at each location recorded for the agency (its own data.json, or a recorded catalog); validate it against the Project Open Data v1.1 JSON schema. Reads: whether any record names the data page's URL in identifier, landingPage, accessURL or downloadURL; schema violations.

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
pass_listed_and_valid	pass	the product has a record in a schema-valid inventory	`m-25-05-phase-2-implementation-of-the-evidence-act-open-gove` §4(a); `dcat-us-1-1-schema` schema	specified

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
fail_catalog_invalid	fail	the inventory does not conform to the required schema	`m-25-05-phase-2-implementation-of-the-evidence-act-open-gove` §5(b)(ii) (must employ the metadata schema approved by OMB)	specified
fail_product_absent	fail	the inventory has no record naming the product's page	`m-25-05-phase-2-implementation-of-the-evidence-act-open-gove` §4(a) (all data assets)	specified
fail_no_catalog	fail	no inventory served at any recorded location	`m-25-05-phase-2-implementation-of-the-evidence-act-open-gove` §4(a)(iii); §5(b)(ii)	specified

Not measured: the recorded inventory could not be verified, or a seed source was not searched (16 of 23 data pages on the cycle of record)

Confounds:

- the dataset's record names a different landing page (a catalog page, a DOI) than the data page measured. Distinguished: no: a fail on the absent branch.
- the inventory is large and its fetch timed out or was refused. Distinguished: yes: error.

Fix line (`act:d4-add-the-product-to-the-public-data-inventory`): "Add the product to the public data inventory already published.", consistent with the expected behavior.

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. Three requirements are attributed to sources without a supporting quoted passage. (a) 'in JSON … hosts it at www.[agency].gov/data.json', attributed to M-25-05 §4(a) and §5(b)(ii): no quoted passage mentions JSON or a data.json location. (b) 'DCAT-US 1.1 defines the record and its fields (identifier, landingPage, distribution accessURL and downloadURL)': the dcat-us-1-1-schema source is cited but no passage from it is quoted at all. (c) 'a public data asset disseminated through the Federal Data Catalog is listed with the URL where it may be accessed': the quote supports only 'including in the agency's comprehensive data inventory the URL or persistent identifier'; the Federal Data Catalog condition is not in any passage. Supported parts: 'comprehensive data inventory of all its data assets' and 'using the OMB-approved metadata schema'. The entry does plainly mark the URL-field membership rule as the project's own.
- Round 2 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source yes; misreading no; undefined terms yes. Every requirement attributed to M-25-05 (comprehensive inventory of all data assets, JSON format, OMB-approved schema on resources.data.gov, hosting at www.[agency].gov/data.json, inclusion of the URL or persistent identifier when disseminating via the Federal Data Catalog) has a matching verbatim passage. The DCAT-US passage supports 'human-friendly page' for the landing field. The membership rule (URL match in identifier, landingPage, accessURL, downloadURL) is explicitly labeled 'chosen by this project' and 'this project's'. Two soft spots fall short of misattribution: the tail 'where the asset may be accessed' is the writer's gloss beyond the truncated 'URL or persistent identifier' quote, and the DCAT-US quote is cut off before naming the landingPage field, so the field name rests on the citation locator rather than the quoted text.

F4 `RULE-F4-v5`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_f4_v5.py`. Client: the harness's identified, robots-compliant client. Request: GET each changelog location recorded for the agency. Reads: Content-Type (JSON, Atom or RSS counts as machine-readable); for a feed, the share of entries carrying a revision-class field.

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
pass_classified_feed	pass	a version history exists (as a classified feed)	`w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 8	specified
fail_entries_unclassified	fail	penalizes a feed whose entries do not carry a change-type field	none	project_defined
fail_changelog_is_a_page	fail	penalizes a version history published as a web page rather than a feed	none	project_defined
fail_no_changelog	fail	no version history at any recorded location	`w3c-dwbp-2017` Best Practice 8	specified

Not measured: refused or robots_disallowed (3 of 23 data pages), or a seed source not searched (2)

Confounds:

- a complete, human-readable revision history page. Distinguished: in the reason only; the cell fails it.
- revisions announced in each release's notes rather than a central history. Distinguished: no.

Fix line (`act:f4-publish-a-version-history-endpoint`): "Publish a version history for the product.", consistent with the expected behavior.

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source yes; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. The two requirements attributed to sources are each backed by a quoted passage: DWBP's 'complete version history that explains the changes made in each version' is quoted verbatim, and USAFacts' 'versioning so AI developers can track updates over time' matches 'versioning that lets developers track updates'. The feed-format and revision-class requirements are stated plainly as not coming from either source, and the Parameters line says both were chosen by this project. The only unquoted wording is the purpose clause 'so that humans and software agents can understand how versions differ', which is a rationale rather than a requirement, and the second DWBP passage ('describing precisely how each version differs') covers its substance.
- The entry was revised after its last reading (its claims or terms, from the reader's answers to questions 2 and 3); that revision has not been read.

A11-declared `RULE-A11-declared-v2`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_a11_declared_v2.py`. Client: the harness's identified client. Request: GET /robots.txt; read the data page's robots meta tags. Reads: per-token verdicts for the same eight tokens as A4; restricting meta-robots tokens.

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
pass_both_permit	pass	both declarations permit every listed token	`rfc-9309-robots-exclusion-protocol` §2.2	specified
fail_nothing_declared	fail	penalizes no robots.txt, which RFC 9309 reads as permitting everything	`rfc-9309-robots-exclusion-protocol` §2.3.1.3 (contradicts the branch)	invalid
fail_token_disallowed	fail	penalizes a training opt-out as if it were a refusal of access	`openai-crawlers-bots` GPTBot (contradicts the branch)	invalid
fail_meta_restricts	fail	the page declares noindex or a similar restriction	https://developers.google.com/search/docs/crawling-indexing/robots-meta-tag Using the robots meta tag	specified

Not measured: the declared layer could not be observed (refusal)

Confounds:

- the same token-list and absent-file problems as A4. Distinguished: no.

Fix line: none (not a grid column).

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. Three attributions lack a supporting passage. (1) The text says RFC 9309 §1 holds that 'the rules are not access authorization'; the only RFC quote is 'then the crawler MAY access any resources on the server', which supports the unavailable-robots.txt point (§2.3.1.3) but says nothing about authorization. (2) The text says training-crawler tokens are opt-outs 'not from answers' and attributes this to OpenAI and Anthropic; the OpenAI quote only says disallowing GPTBot means content should not be used in training, and no Anthropic passage is quoted at all (Anthropic is not even in the cited-sources list). (3) The Google clause 'that are allowed to fetch the page' goes beyond the quoted 'rule applies to search engine crawlers'. The cloudflare source named under the question also has no quoted passage. None of these parts is marked as the project's own.
- Round 2 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. Most attributions are backed: 'not a form of access authorization' (RFC 9309), 'can be read and followed only if crawlers are allowed to access the pages' (Google), the GPTBot training and OAI-SearchBot search-results statements (OpenAI), and the ClaudeBot training-exclusion signal (Anthropic) all appear verbatim, and the closing inference about answers is presented as the project's own reading. Two attributions outrun the quoted passages. The text says RFC 9309 §2.3.1.3 holds that 'a robots.txt the server reports as unavailable' lets the crawler access any resources (and the fail_nothing_declared branch and the claims rest on this), but the quoted fragment is only the consequent 'then the crawler MAY access any resources on the server' with no condition shown; the 'unavailable' antecedent is supplied by the writer. Likewise the text says the Google 'noindex rule applies to search engine crawlers', but the quote is only 'rule applies to search engine crawlers', so which rule is asserted by the writer, not the passage.

A12 `RULE-A12-v3`

Code: `assessment/harness/scan/rules/rule_a12_v3.py`. Client: the harness's identified client (params.manners.user_agent). Request: GET /robots.txt; GET the data page's path as the same client. Reads: robots.txt status and verdict for this client; the probe's status.

Branch	Verdict	Behavior	Source	State
fail_robots_refused	fail	the host refuses the client at /robots.txt	none	project_defined
fail_nothing_declared	fail	penalizes a missing robots.txt, which RFC 9309 reads as declaring permission	`rfc-9309-robots-exclusion-protocol` §2.3.1.3 (contradicts the branch)	invalid
fail_permitted_but_refused	fail	permitted in robots.txt, refused at the edge	none	project_defined
pass_coherent	pass	permitted and served	none	project_defined

Not measured: no response to either request; a 5xx on the probe

Confounds:

- the edge refuses this scanner's user agent specifically (an unknown bot) while admitting named crawlers. Distinguished: no.

Fix line: none (not a grid column).

Reader (DN-015 §7; role `judge`):

- Round 1 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source no; misreading yes; undefined terms yes. The not-access-control claim (§1, §3) and the 'MAY access any resources on the server' claim are supported by quoted passages, and the coherence requirement is plainly labeled the project's own construct. But the expected-behavior text attributes to RFC 9309 §2.3.1.3 that 'a 4xx makes the file "unavailable"', quoting 'unavailable' as verbatim; no quoted passage contains 'unavailable' or '4xx', and the quoted fragment 'then the crawler MAY access…' lacks its antecedent, so the 4xx-equals-permission condition the fail_nothing_declared branch is judged against rests on text not shown.
- Round 2 (`claude-fable-5-1`): source yes; misreading yes; undefined terms no. Every requirement the expected-behavior text attributes to RFC 9309 is matched by a quoted passage: rules are not access authorization, not a substitute for content security measures, the definition of 'unavailable' with the HTTP 400-499 example, and that the crawler MAY then access any resources. The declaration–enforcement coherence the check actually measures is stated plainly to be the project's own construct with no source. The Cloudflare page named in the question header has no quoted passage, but the expected-behavior text attributes no requirement to it, so nothing unsupported is claimed as a source's requirement.
- The entry was revised after its last reading (its claims or terms, from the reader's answers to questions 2 and 3); that revision has not been read.